

Q&A

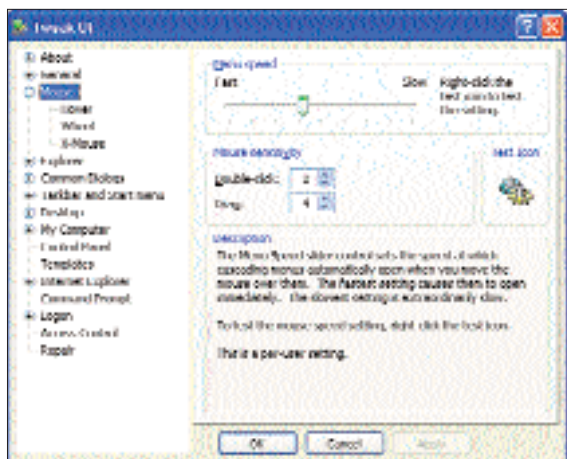
Your Questions, Our Answers

Quick-Start

Q Whenever I click on a folder in the Start menu, it seems to take ages to open. Is there any way I can speed things up a bit?

Madhav Kumar

A Yes, you can easily alter the speed at which these menus appear, and there are a couple of ways to go about it. Go to **Start > Run**, type in “regedit” in the dialog box and click OK. Navigate to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control_Panel\Desktop**. In the right-hand pane, you should see a key called **MenuShowDelay** with a (default)



Adjust menu speed in TweakUI

value of 400. This is the number of milliseconds that elapse before Windows shows you a menu. Double-click on this entry and enter a lower value to speed things up. Alternatively, download TweakUI from www.microsoft.com/windowsxp/downloads/powertoys/xppowertoys.msp. This is a great tool that allows you to safely perform a number of tweaks without opening the Registry Editor. In the Mouse section of the program, you can adjust the “Menu speed” slider as required.

A Larger Clipboard?

Q I am using Windows 98, and I frequently copy and paste text and images from one document to other. The clipboard that's built into Windows is limited to holding one piece of text or one image at a time. So I have to constantly flick back and forth between files if I have to copy a number of items. Is there any way to increase the amount of information the clipboard can hold?

Senthil Venkataraman

A Windows 98 comes with a host of secret tools hidden on the installation CD—one of these tools is a handy little program called ClipTray, which greatly extends the capabilities of the clipboard. Install the Windows 98 Resource Kit from the **\Tools\reskit** folder of the Windows CD. Once this is installed, go to **Start > Programs > Windows 98 Resource Kit > Tools Management Console**. From here, you can launch ClipTray in the Desktop Tools section. Double-click on the new System Tray icon to add entries to the ClipTray list. Enter a title for your clipboard item and paste in the text you want and click in Add. When you have added a few entries, right-click on the System Tray icon and select which clipboard item you would like to paste.

Function-Key Frustration

Q I often need to boot my Windows XP computer into Safe Mode to fix problems—most of them created by me. The problem is only a minor niggle, that is, I find getting into the Safe Mode by pressing [F8] a bit frustrating, especially when I do not press the key at the right time and miss the train. Is there any way I can create a Desktop shortcut that shuts down my computer and restarts it in Safe Mode?

Vinit Prabhu

A There is no way to create a Desktop shortcut that restarts Windows in Safe Mode. But there is an alternative, which we think is worth mentioning and which you may find useful. If you have more than one operating system installed, you're presented with a boot menu that asks you which version of Windows you'd like to load. You can set up this feature to be able to choose whether you want to boot into Normal Mode or Safe Mode.

Right-click on My Computer and select Properties. Click the Advanced tab and then the Settings button under “Startup and Recovery”. Click the Edit button towards the top of the dialog box, and Notepad should open a file called boot.ini. Under the “[operating system]” line, you will see a line “multi(0)disk(0)...”. Copy this line and paste it on to the line below. Go to the end of this newly-added line and add a space, then `/safeboot:minimal /sos /booting`. Change the words inside the quotes to “Windows XP Safe Mode”. Close Notepad and save the file. When you restart Windows, you will see a menu asking you if you want to start Windows normally or if you want to use Safe Mode. The menu will automatically select normal Windows in 30 seconds.

Pop-Up Begone!

Q I have two 250 GB hard drives installed. Recently, I moved my Windows XP swap file to the second drive. I configured it to use all available free space thinking that I may never have to worry about running short of memory again. Everything is running smoothly, as I'd expected, apart from the nagging pop-up warning me that I am running out of free space on this drive. Since I have intentionally set this, I wish to get rid of this pop-up.

Ganesh Menon